

Week 3 — Pulse Diagnosis

Class: Friday July 25, 2026 · 9AM–1PM
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Jonathan Centeno, D.AcHM Candidate

REQUIRED READINGS — DUE BEFORE JULY 25

FCM CHAPTER 25 — MACIOCIA

- The Normal Pulse (平脈 Píng Mài)
- Three essential qualities: 胃神根
- 28 pulse qualities — full descriptions
- Clinical groupings by pattern
- Pulse qualities at individual positions

CAM CHAPTER 13 — CHENG XINNONG

- Normal pulse description
- 28 pathological pulse types
- Yin/Yang classification of pulses
- Pulse-taking method review
- Pulse qualities in disease

WEEK 3 LEARNING OBJECTIVES (CLO 1, 4, 5, 6)

- Describe the characteristics of a normal pulse
- Name the three essential qualities (胃神根) and explain each
- Identify the 28 classical pulse qualities by feel and name
- Classify pulses by Yin/Yang grouping (CAM framework)
- Explain what each pulse quality indicates clinically
- Differentiate easily confused pulse pairs (e.g., Wiry vs Tight)
- Apply pulse findings to the six positions bilaterally
- Integrate pulse with tongue for pattern differentiation

ASSESSMENT CALENDAR

Date	Event	Material Covered
Jul 24	⚠ Quiz 2	Week 2: Four Pillars, 8 Principles, Tongue intro, Pulse intro
Jul 25	Week 3 Class	Normal Pulse, 28 Pulse Qualities, in-class palpation practice
Jul 31	Quiz 3	Week 3 material — Pulse Diagnosis
Aug 7	MIDTERM + Journal 1–25	Weeks 1–4 comprehensive
Sep 11	FINAL + Journal 26–50	Weeks 6–9 comprehensive

IN-CLASS PRACTICE — WHAT TO EXPECT FRIDAY

PALPATION LAB

Week 3 includes hands-on in-class practice on pulse palpation. Come ready to:

- Practice three-finger placement on a partner (Cun/Guan/Chi bilaterally)
- Identify depth levels — superficial, middle, deep
- Attempt to name at least 3–5 qualities you feel in a live practice pulse
- Document your findings in your Pulse/Tongue Journal (entry counts toward midterm)

PULSE POSITIONS — 寸關尺 · BOTH HANDS

Hand	Cun 寸 (distal)	Guan 關 (middle)	Chi 尺 (proximal)
Left Heart side	Heart / SM Intestine chest, Pericardium	Liver / Gallbladder	Kidney Yin / Bladder Lower Jiao (L)
Right Lung side	Lung / LG Intestine chest	Spleen / Stomach	Kidney Yang / Bladder Lower Jiao (R)

NORMAL PULSE 平脈 · THREE ESSENTIALS 胃神根

Quality	Normal Finding	Essential	Meaning
Rate	4–5 beats/resp · 72–80 bpm	胃 Wèi	Stomach Qi: flowing, harmonious
Depth	Middle level — not too sup/deep	神 Shén	Spirit: strong, rhythmical
Strength	Forceful but not excessive	根 Gēn	Root: deep at Chi — Kidney Qi
Rhythm	Regular — no skipped beats		

28 PULSE QUALITIES — QUICK REFERENCE

↑ FLOATING GROUP	WIDTH / SHAPE GROUP
浮 Fú Floating Exterior / Yin def	弦 Xián Wiry Liver · pain · violin string
芤 Kōu Hollow Blood/fluid loss	滑 Huá Slippery Phlegm · pearls rolling
革 Gé Leather Jing/Blood loss	澀 Sè Choppy Blood stasis · scraping
↓ SINKING GROUP	洪 Hóng Flooding Excess Heat · wave
沉 Chén Deep Interior	細 Xì Thin Blood def · thread
牢 Láo Firm Cold accumulation	濡 Rú Soggy Damp · float+thin+soft
伏 Fú Hidden Severe Interior Cold	長 Cháng Long Excess · past positions
RHYTHM GROUP	短 Duǎn Short Qi def/stag · one position
結 Jié Knotted Slow + irreg. skips	緊 Jǐn Tight Cold · twisted rope
促 Cù Hurried Rapid + irreg. skips	大 Dà Overflowing Full Heat · wide
代 Dài Reg. Intermit. Slow + fixed gaps △	
RATE GROUP	△ Key Distinctions to Know
數 Shuò Rapid >5/resp — Heat	Wiry vs Tight: Wiry = taut violin string · Tight = twisted vibrating rope (colder, more pain)
遲 Chí Slow <4/resp — Cold	Slippery vs Flooding: Slippery = smooth rolling (normal width) · Flooding = large wave (big force)
疾 Jí Racing >7/resp — extreme Heat	代 Dài = worst rhythm: regular fixed-interval skips = organ Qi declining
緩 Huǎn Moderate 4/resp — Damp/normal	
STRENGTH GROUP	
實 Shí Full Excess — forceful all levels	
虛 Xū Empty Def — weak all levels	
弱 Ruò Weak Deep + fine + soft	
微 Wēi Frail Barely perceptible	

EAM Diagnosis Notes

EAM310 · EAM Diagnosis I · Prof. Schrier · Friday 9AM–1PM · Room 303

FOLDER_EAM310 · Week 3 Insert
July 25, 2026

PATTERN NAME	DISEASE CATEGORY	WEEK / QUIZ
ETIOLOGY	ORGAN SYSTEM	DATE

CLINICAL ESSENTIALS · TONGUE · PULSE · TREATMENT PRINCIPLE

TONGUE 舌診	PULSE 脈診 · CUN · GUAN · CHI																				
CHINESE MEDICINE TONGUE MAP COLOR / COAT / SHAPE	<table><tr><th>Wrist</th><th>CUN 寸</th><th>GUAN 關</th><th>CHI 尺</th></tr><tr><td>L HT/PC</td><td></td><td>LV/GB</td><td>KD-Yin</td></tr><tr><td>R LU/LI</td><td></td><td>SP/ST</td><td>KD-Yang</td></tr><tr><td colspan="4">QUALITY / OVERALL</td></tr><tr><td colspan="4"></td></tr></table>	Wrist	CUN 寸	GUAN 關	CHI 尺	L HT/PC		LV/GB	KD-Yin	R LU/LI		SP/ST	KD-Yang	QUALITY / OVERALL							
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TREATMENT PRINCIPLE 治則

KEY POINTS / HERBS

